## Memo

**Maven (YC W26) lets voice AI agents collect payments during live calls.** ***Think of them as Stripe Checkout, but for phone calls.***

Voice AI has crossed the threshold where it can handle real customer conversations — qualifying leads, booking appointments, negotiating pricing — **but the moment a customer says they are ready to pay, the entire interaction breaks down.**

Collecting a payment over the phone requires PCI-compliant infrastructure, secure card data handling, failed payment retry logic, and integrations with multiple payment gateways, all orchestrated in the middle of a live call.

Most voice AI teams either avoid payments entirely or build the infrastructure themselves, which is slow, expensive, and not their core competency. Maven solves this with a single API call.

**Maven handles payments for voice agents with a single API call. When a customer is ready to pay, the agent triggers Maven and it handles the payment flow end to end.**

The company became PCI compliant on February 25th, 2026, and started selling the same week.

Three weeks later, it had **reached $70k ARR**.

Launch Video

It is now working directly with Retell AI — one of the leading voice AI platforms — to power payments for their hundreds of thousands of developers and 3,000+ business customers. Customers already live include Avoca, Aviary AI, Corafone, and Fluents.ai.

Maven is infrastructure, not application software. The analogy to Stripe is intentional: just as Stripe abstracted away the complexity of internet payments for web developers, Maven abstracts away the complexity of phone payments for voice AI developers.

Every voice AI agent that closes a transaction is a potential Maven customer. As voice AI scales from a novelty into a primary revenue channel across home services, healthcare, insurance, sales, and collections, the payment infrastructure layer beneath it becomes one of the most important chokepoints in the stack — and Maven is building to own it.

We are investing alongside Y Combinator (Airbnb, Stripe), Peak XV (FKA Sequoia SEA; Meesho Pinelabs), Robinhood Ventures (Mercor, Databricks), Blast VC (Latitude, Overseed) and angels.

- **Product Need** - Voice AI agents are being deployed at scale across home services, healthcare, insurance, sales, and collections. They are already replacing inbound and outbound call center functions. The next step — and the step that unlocks voice AI's full revenue potential — is completing transactions on the call. Without payment infrastructure purpose-built for this context, that step fails every time. Maven is the only company building exactly this layer, at exactly this moment.
- **Strong Early Validation** - They are already at $70k ARR 3 weeks into launch. This is not a slow enterprise sales motion — it is a developer-led adoption pattern where the product sells itself because it solves a specific, acute, well-understood problem with a single API call. The speed of the zero-to-revenue transition is one of the strongest early signals we look for in infrastructure companies.
- **Stellar partnerships to streamline distribution** - Retell AI is one of the leading voice AI development platforms, serving hundreds of thousands of developers and 3,000+ businesses. Working directly with Retell to power payments means Maven's infrastructure is embedded at the platform level — not sold deal by deal to individual companies. Every Retell customer who wants to collect payments is a potential Maven customer. This is how infrastructure companies achieve non-linear distribution: not through direct sales, but through platform partnerships that make them the default choice.
- **Regulatory Moat** - PCI compliance is not a feature — it is a precondition for doing business in payments. Achieving it requires passing a rigorous audit, maintaining ongoing compliance programs, and building infrastructure that keeps card data off customer servers. Maven did this before it started selling. For every voice AI team that wants to add payments, the alternative to Maven is not another vendor — it is building and maintaining PCI-compliant infrastructure themselves, which most teams are not equipped to do and should not be spending time on.
- **Data Moat** - Once a payment is made it is tokenized and stored forever. Every call builds a proprietary mapping of caller identity to payment credentials - gateway agnostic, cross merchant and is locked in their vault.
- **Misson Oriented Team** - Brandon (CEO) built software at Meta; Wasi (CTO) is a USA Computing Olympiad Gold division finalist who also worked at Amazon. Both are UC Berkeley alumni. The longevity of the relationship, combined with the technical depth from Amazon and Meta, produces the kind of low-coordination-cost, high-trust founding pair that infrastructure companies need: one team that can build fast and ship reliably without burning cycles on interpersonal friction.

**Problem**

# payments

- PCI compliance nightmare
- Integrations with legacy payment gateways
- Transcription models bad w/ credit cards
- Human handoff, low conversion SMS checkout links, legacy IVR based dialpad solutions

Voice AI agents have crossed a meaningful capability threshold. They can hold natural conversations, respond to objections, handle complex multi-turn dialogue, and take actions — booking appointments, qualifying leads, negotiating pricing. The enterprise voice AI market is scaling rapidly across home services, healthcare, insurance, sales, and collections. Businesses are deploying these agents because they work.

But there is a ceiling on the value any voice AI agent can deliver, and it is defined by a single question: can it actually close a transaction? When a customer says they are ready to pay, the answer today is almost always no — or at best, a deeply awkward handoff to a human or a follow-up text link that kills conversion. The problem is not the voice AI. The problem is that collecting a payment over the phone requires infrastructure that most voice AI teams have not built and cannot reasonably build.

- PCI compliance: card data handling is governed by strict Payment Card Industry standards. Collecting, transmitting, or storing card data without PCI-compliant infrastructure is a regulatory violation with serious financial and legal consequences.
- Secure card collection: card numbers, expiration dates, and CVVs cannot flow through voice AI platforms or customer servers without triggering PCI scope. They must route directly through compliant infrastructure.
- Retry logic: payment failures happen in real time, mid-call. Handling declined cards, insufficient funds, and network errors gracefully — without dropping the customer or killing the conversation — requires logic that most teams have never built.
- Gateway integrations: enterprise customers use Stripe, Authorize.net, Adyen, and other gateways depending on their business model and geography. Building and maintaining integrations across all of them is ongoing engineering overhead.

**Solution**

## Stripe Checkout, but for phone calls

- PCI compliant out of the box
- One API, every payment gateway
- Built for spoken card numbers

Maven solves the payment problem for voice AI with a single API call. When a customer indicates they are ready to pay, the voice agent triggers Maven's API. Maven takes over: it handles secure card collection, routes card data directly through its PCI-compliant infrastructure without touching customer servers, processes the payment, manages any failed payment retry logic, and returns a result to the agent. The agent then continues the conversation.

The developer experience is deliberately simple. There is no payment UI to build, no PCI audit to pass, no gateway integration to maintain. Maven handles all of it. The API design mirrors the philosophy that made Stripe successful in web payments: abstract all the complexity, expose a clean interface, and let developers focus on their core product.

## Data Moat! - Digital Voice Wallet

Phone number → tokenized card. Collected once, reused forever.

Every call builds a proprietary mapping of caller identity to payment credentials - gateway-agnostic, cross-merchant, and locked in our vault.

The more merchants on Maven, the more callers already have a card on file. Competitors start every call from scratch.

Card data flows directly through Maven's PCI-compliant infrastructure and never touches the voice AI platform or the customer's servers. This is not just a convenience feature — it is what makes compliance possible for voice AI companies that would otherwise have to scope their entire infrastructure for PCI requirements the moment they touch card data.

The integration works across the major voice AI platforms — including Retell AI, where Maven is now the embedded payment layer for hundreds of thousands of developers and 3,000+ businesses —

**Market**

## $5B+ TAM

- 1B+ payment calls/year in US call centers alone, 3.5B+ globally
- $80B in call center labor shifting to AI, those agents still need to collect payments
- At $1.25/transaction, that's $5B+ in revenue opportunity

The voice AI market is early but growing fast. Retell AI alone serves hundreds of thousands of developers and 3,000+ businesses. Vapi, Bland, and a growing list of platform competitors serve similar numbers. Every voice AI agent that is deployed in a context where a customer might pay — which includes virtually all of home services, healthcare billing, insurance, sales, and debt collections — is a potential Maven customer.

The total payment volume that flows through voice AI agents is not yet measurable because the infrastructure to capture it does not yet exist at scale. Maven is building before the volume arrives, which is the right time: the companies that build payment infrastructure at the platform level get embedded early and are extraordinarily difficult to displace once the volume is flowing through them.

**Traction**

- **Feb 25th —** PCI compliant. Started selling the same week.
- **3 weeks later** — $70k ARR
- **Now** — Working directly with Retell AI to power payments for their hundreds of thousands of voice AI developers and 3,000+ businesses.

**Team**

## Friends since 5th grade
## Engineers from Berkeley, Meta & Amazon

**Brandon Boehme**
CEO

**Wasi Ahmed**
CTO

USA Computing Olympiad

**Brandon Boehme, Co-founder & CEO.** Software engineer background from Meta and Amazon. UC Berkeley alumnus. Brandon brings the go-to-market intuition and relationship-driven sales motion that early infrastructure companies need — the ability to find the right platform partners and embed Maven at the distribution layer before competitors realize the opportunity exists.

**Wasi Ahmed, Co-founder & CTO.** Rank #1 in the USA Computing Olympiad Gold Division. Software engineer at Amazon. UC Berkeley alumnus. Wasi brings the algorithmic depth and systems engineering experience required to build reliable, high-throughput payment infrastructure — the kind of software that has to work perfectly every time, at scale, in the middle of a live phone call.